



NVIDIA has launched their entry-level GeForce GTX 210 and 220 desktop graphics GPUs



IEEE Draft N2 finally becomes 'N' as all Draft N devices are deemed compatible with the final 802.11n standard

Agent 001

**Q** I have a Sony Ericsson W810i mobile. My old handsfree is dead and of no use. So now I want a good replacement for it. My budget is Rs.1000 to 1300. I've 2 options: buy costlier SE handsfree like the HPM-85 or better. Or, the buy lower SE handsfree (just for connecting to phone) + Creative EP630 earphones.

I've read lot of good things about Creative EP630 in your magazine. I want to know from you which way should I go? Or is there any better option available?

**Bipin Thite**

**A** I recommend buying just the regular handsfree kit and buying a Creative EP630 that will give you much better quality even when listening to music, even when you are not using the handsfree unit. The EP630 can be had for under Rs. 1,000 from many vendors like computer and cellphone shops.

**Q** I am planning to buy a laptop. My budget is 40-45 K. I am a B.E final year student of computer science. So I need a decent laptop. The brand doesn't matter. But a brand with good after sale service will do good. I am also a gamer so I need a laptop of that kind. And I am not going to travel often so the backup or compactness is not mandatory but a fair battery backup of 3 hours will be nice. So please suggest guys.

**Kannan. R**

**A** I recommend Acer's Aspire 5738G; available for Rs. 40,999 – it has very good specifications and a good graphics solution. Getting three hours of battery life from a notebook with a fast CPU and good graphics is not really possible so I suggest if you game please sacrifice on the battery life. Acer's service reputation is pretty good and the 5738G isn't overly heavy but has a nice 15.6-inch LED-backlit display.

**Q** I would like to buy a PC for purely multitasking, playing high quality games, watching full HD movies, etc. I have decided to buy an AMD Phenom II X4 940 3 GHz and NVIDIA GTX 260 graphics card. What choice of motherboard and SMPS

should I opt for? I want my motherboard to have Ethernet Port, Fire-Wire port and at least 4 USB ports. I want to add a sound card. My budget is 50,000.

**Ashish Mathew**

**A** First of all the applications you have mentioned are not really multithreaded a great deal so four cores will not necessarily be better than two. However, taking future proofing into the angle I recommend an Intel processor over an AMD – and your budget of Rs. 50,000 will allow you to easily opt for either a Core 2 Quad or a Core i7/i5 based system. With the former processor your platform will be cheaper giving you more money to spend on a graphics card while with the Core i7/i5 system the motherboard will cost much more meaning you have less to spend on the video card – which is more important for gaming. I recommend a Core 2 Duo based system based around a Core 2 Quad Q9550 CPU (Rs. 12,500), ASUS

#### thinkdigit news

The Web is abuzz with news that Nvidia might be killing its GT200 series of graphics cards. It all started with SemiAccurate's Charlie Demerjian – who has long been criticised as a 'tech tabloid' writer by all and sundry – stating that the company is set to kill its GeForce GTX285, GTX275, and GTX260 graphics cards, and possibly the GTX295 too; thus abandoning the entire high-range and mid-range graphics. Read more at [www.thinkdigit.com/d/55378](http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/55378).

P5Q-E motherboard (Rs. 9,000), 4 GB DDR2 800 MHz (Rs. 4000), 500 GB Western Digital hard drive (Rs. 3700) and if your budget permits, a ZOTAC GeForce GTX 285 (Rs. 23,000) – which is a superb performer. In case you also need a monitor that will cut into your GPU budget (since you haven't mentioned anything), I recommend a Palit ATi Radeon HD 4890 card (Rs. 17,500). For an SMPS I recommend Corsair's TX 650W available for Rs. 6,200. All motherboards these days come

with at least four USB ports, Ethernet and the ability to add soundcards. FireWire isn't a necessity but this motherboard has this port as well.

**Q** I want to buy a digital camera with high optical zoom and better performance. I have a budget of Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 22,000. I have visited various web sites for cameras and found several models suitable. Let me know your suggest.

**Aditya Didwania**

**A** Canon's SX10 IS should be available on the street at around that price. If not, Canon's SX200 IS will definitely suit. In fact I feel the SX200 IS is better built due to its smaller size and partially metal body. The SX10 IS has a 20x optical zoom, while the SX200 IS has a very neat 12x optical zoom. From our tests the SX20 IS had slightly better low light performance, however, owing to its longer zoom the output is pretty susceptible to barrel distortion. I recommend the SX200 IS.

**Q** I want to buy a processor and a motherboard for my gaming PC. I'm considering Intel i7 920, Intel Core 2 Quad Q9650 or Q8400. I don't know which motherboard to buy for it but it should support 8GB RAM and a PCIe slot for my NVIDIA 8600GT 512MB GDDR3. My budget is around Rs. 16,000. Will I be able to play games like Prototype at maximum details and resolution?

**Sumant kumar**

**A** You are naming high-end components for a mere NVIDIA 8600GT. I think you need to upgrade that graphics card before buying such components. I recommend at least a ZOTAC GTX 260 available for Rs. 11,500 that will utilise such components properly. Your budget is way too paltry for a Core i7/i5 system. Therefore, go with a Core 2 Duo E8400 and ASUS P5Q-E board for Rs. 8,000 and Rs 9,000 respectively. If you want a cheaper motherboard BioStar's TPower i45 is available for Rs. 7,900 and will also suit the E8400. **[i]**

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